



RAA.SPACE — Cultural Space

Radošā rūpnīca Veldze, Matīsa iela 8, Rīga LV-1001



E-mail	Instagram	Address
enter@raa.space	@raa_riga	Matīsa iela 8, Rīga LV-1001

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About

RAA is an independent cultural space located in Radošā rūpnīca Veldze in central Riga, Latvia. It opened on **11 July 2025**.

The space hosts a diverse programme: contemporary art exhibitions, theatre performances, concerts, poetry readings, workshops, festivals, and community gatherings.

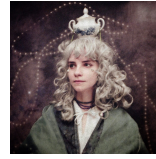
The space comprises an exhibition hall (103 m²), an entrance foyer (35 m²), a theatre room (13 m²) with a dedicated foyer, a backstage corridor, and access to a courtyard connecting the entire Veldze quarter.

RAA (aka *reductio ad absurdum*) leads claims to absurdity since 2025. At RAA you do not have to be loud to be heard.

Team



Leonhard Horstmeyer
master of disaster



Jana Zariņa
artistic director



Helias Dzimoulakis
theatre director

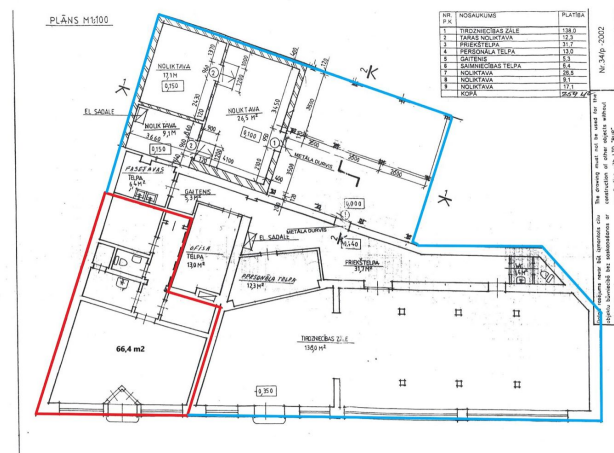
MAATE NAATRE

MAATE NAATRE is a herbal bar located in the entrance foyer of RAA, part of Radošā rūpnīca Veldze in central Riga. Opened on 14 March 2026, it is a small place to linger, meet others, and taste a variety of nature-crafted drinks. The bar brings the Latvian forest to the city — try different cocktails from the forest.

Layout



Main hall



Layout of RAA (without the red area)

Timeline

July 2025 RAA opened its doors on 11 July 2025. Inaugural group exhibition *In Your Shoes*, curated by Maija Kurševa, brought together seven artists from the Latvian Academy of Art. Poetry marathon *Sinusoid* with Syntax Stupor.

August 2025 Katoptron Teātris, RAA's resident theatre, opened under the direction of Helias Dzimoulakis. Arta Raituma led a two-day fire workshop followed by an exhibition of the resulting works. Solo exhibition *Saules Gaismas Meklējumos* by Fricis Ripa. Musical evening with Elza & Uģis Albiņš. Photography exhibition by Ksenija Kumačova.

September 2025 Exhibition connected to the international theatre festival Homo Novus. Sewing Machine Techno. British poet Joëlle Taylor (T.S. Eliot Prize winner) gave a reading. Launch of Tvērums #11. Evening with Erika Kolobanova & Konstantins Belih.

October 2025 Three-day International Scent Art Festival (10–12 Oct) with international artists. res Tacta performance and workshop series. Brīvības Experience (16–30 Oct) — urban installation about Riga's main street by Brunis Kibilds.

November 2025 Kefirs Studio group exhibition. First Riga Upcycling Festival (15 Nov). Photography exhibition by Veronika Geida. *Through the Looking Glass* — photography by Paula Betija Anteniške documenting Ivo Krieviņš and the Riga ballroom scene.

December 2025 WunderKombināts publication launch. Piano recital with Andrejs Osokins. Tvērums December issue launch.

January 2026 Winter break and renovation works at RAA.

February 2026 30-day evolving installation *AS DISTANT, SO NEAR* with various artists, exploring themes of distance, proximity, and presence.

March 2026 Opening of MAATE NAATRE forest bar (14 Mar). Three research meetup sessions. Book presentation. Weavers group exhibition and performance *Dialogo ad Infinitum* by Leonhard Horstmeyer.

April 2026 *ALTERNATĪVA: Traces from the Underground* — exhibition by the 2ANNAS film festival (10 Apr – 4 May), with four artists and three guided tours, supported by Rīgas dome and VKKF.

May 2026 Group exhibition *Atrodi mani, es esmu šeit* by students of the Latvian Academy of Art. Duo exhibition *TP054K-01xG* by Alīna Burlakova and Viktorija Galkina (15 May – 8 Jun), including a Gallery Late evening within Riga Art Week with a performance by Elizabete Balčus.

June 2026 Annual product design exhibition of Rīgas Dizaina un mākslas vidusskola. Start of *Macchiato XVI — Sauleszaķi*, the 16th festival of the international collective Macchiato Celebratio artis.

July 2026 *ITEM — Shuffled Time* (5–11 Jul) — a seven-day performative week giving each artist a 24-hour window in the space. First anniversary of RAA. Fotoklubs.lv photography exhibition. RAA Chess Week (20–24 Jul) — talks, a Hands and Brain tournament, poetry and theatre, and the Latvian premiere of the Baroque opera *Blaise le Savetier* by chess master F.-A.-D. Philidor.

August 2026 *Architecture of Feeling* — early Baroque concert by the Lithuanian Ensemble Sans Frayeur with guest musicians from Italy and Latvia.

Events

All events hosted at RAA since opening on 11 July 2025, in chronological order. Many more events for 2026 are planned but not yet listed here.

July 2025



11 July 2025

R A A Opening #1

The inaugural opening of RAA cultural space at Matīsa iela 8.

Opening



11–18 July 2025

In Your Shoes

Group exhibition curated by Maija Kurševa (3rd-year LMA KAS students). Each work references another artist's practice. Seven participating artists.

Exhibition



24–27 July 2025

Typewriter Museum Exhibition

20th-century typewriter collection from Germany, USA, Sweden, and Italy. Visitors could type on two authentic machines.

Exhibition



27 July 2025

Poetry: Sinusoid

Poetry marathon by the group Syntax Stupor, with music by Dabsolis and Kaspars Sils. Open microphone.

Poetry / Music

August 2025



2–3 August 2025

Fire Workshop with Arta Raituma

Two-day experimental wood-burning workshop with artist Arta Raituma.

Workshop



4–6 August 2025

Fire Workshop Exhibition

Exhibition of artworks created during Arta Raituma's fire workshop.

Exhibition



7–10 August 2025

Kas Aug Starp Mums

Photography exhibition by Ksenija Kumačova (b. 1997). Explores the interaction between humans and local nature.

Exhibition



9 August 2025

Katoptron Teātris Opening

Opening of RAA's resident theatre, founded and directed by Helias Dzimoulakis.

Theatre



14 August 2025

Kabiirijas Salons #1

Open stage for painting, music, performance, dance, and poetry.

Performance / Open Stage



14–17 August 2025

RAA Museum: Shelf Stories

A museum of objects donated by community members, each with its story.

Exhibition



18–26 August 2025

Saules Gaismas Meklējumos

Solo exhibition by Fricis Ripa — *In Search of Sunshine*. Opening with DJ sets.

Exhibition



28 August 2025

Laime Plīst uz Traukiem

An evening performance event.

Performance

September 2025



1 September 2025

Second Variety Show

An evening of varied acts and performances.

Performance



3 September 2025

Cities by Night

Evening event exploring urban themes through art and performance.

Event



8 September 2025

Joëlle Taylor — Reading

Poetry reading with British poet Joëlle Taylor, T.S. Eliot Prize winner.

Literature / Poetry



14 September 2025

Sewing Machine Techno

An evening combining craft, community, and rhythm.

Workshop / Event

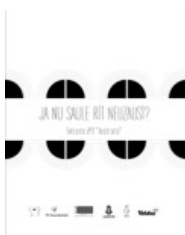


17 September 2025

Folk Songs

A creative afternoon and evening of singing, writing, drawing, and sharing — an open space to explore Latvian folk songs through music and creative expression.

Music / Workshop



18 September 2025

Literature / Launch

Tvērums #11 “East”: What If the Sun Doesn’t Rise Tomorrow

Launch of the 11th issue of the literary journal Tvērums, themed around East and uncertainty.



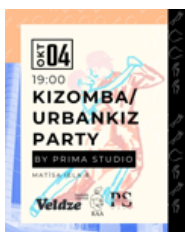
27 September 2025

Exhibition

Exo — Photography Exhibition

Photography exhibition.

October 2025



4 October 2025

Dance / Party

Kizomba / UrbanKiz Party

Social dance party with Kizomba and UrbanKiz music.



5 October 2025

Community

Riga Sock Exchange

Community clothing exchange event.



8 October 2025

Performance / Workshop

res tacta — Performance / Creative Workshop

Performance and workshop exploring tactile experience and bodily presence.

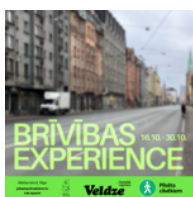


10–12 October 2025

Festival

International Scent Art Festival

Three-day international festival dedicated to olfactory art — exhibitions, performances, workshops, and a scent tour of Riga.



16–30 October 2025

Event

Brīvības Experience — Urban Installation

Exhibition and urban installation dedicated to Riga's main street, Brīvības iela. Using visualizations, 3D models, and other media, the project explores the street's history, current state, and future scenarios. Organized by Brunis Kibilds (Pilsēta cilvēkiem / City for People). Visitors were invited to participate in rethinking how to make the city more people-friendly.

November 2025



6–9 November 2025

Exhibition

Kefirs Studio Exhibition

Group exhibition by Kefirs Studio.



15 November 2025

Festival

The First Riga Upcycling Festival

Public event promoting sustainable design and reuse culture. Workshops, market stalls, and community activities.



17 November 2025

Exhibition

(pa)liekas — Photography Exhibition

Solo photography exhibition by Veronika Geida.



24–30 November 2025

Exhibition

Through the Looking Glass

Photography exhibition exploring queer identity and ballroom culture in Latvia. Photography by Paula Betija Antenišķe, documenting Ivo Krieviņš and the Riga ballroom scene. Supported by the European Union.

December 2025



9 December 2025

WunderKombināts — Publication Launch

Launch of the WunderKombināts publication.

Literature / Launch



12 December 2025

Concert with Andrejs Osokins

Piano concert with Andrejs Osokins.

Concert



19 December 2025

Tvērums — December Issue Launch

Launch of the December issue of literary journal Tvērums.

Literature / Launch



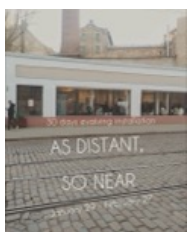
28 December 2025

Mārkis Ozoliņš — Concert Evening

Concert evening with Mārkis Ozoliņš.

Concert

January 2026



29 January 2026

AS DISTANT, SO NEAR — Open Call

Open call and exhibition exploring themes of distance, proximity, and presence.

Launch of a 30-day evolving installation with various participating artists.

Exhibition / Open Call

March 2026



14 March 2026

Festival

2nd Upcycling Festival “Refresh the Old!”

Second edition of the Riga Upcycling Festival. Market, workshops, and community activities.



14 March 2026

Opening

MAATE NAATRE — Opening

Opening of MAATE NAATRE herbal bar within the RAA space.



17, 24 & 27 March 2026

Meetup / Research

Research Meetup Series

Three open gatherings at RAA for sharing insights, learning, and collective inquiry.

Citizen Research Meetup (17 Mar) — launch of open weekly sessions to share data-driven questions and learn new skills. Hosted by jopalesi.science. **Recreational Research Meetup** (24 Mar) — informal exchange of ideas and curious questions among participants. **Extraordinary Meeting: Riemann-Zeta** (27 Mar) — special session dedicated to the Riemann-Zeta function and mathematical beauty.



26 March 2026

Exhibition

Weavers — Exhibition

Textile and interdisciplinary exhibition exploring weaving as metaphor and practice.



26 March 2026

Performance

Dialogo ad Infinitum — Performance

Performance by Leonhard Horstmeyer. Part of the Weavers exhibition.



28 March 2026

Laimes Govs

Community morning event.

Event

April – May 2026



10 April – 4 May 2026

ALTERNATĪVA: Traces from the Underground

Exhibition by the Riga International Short Film Festival 2ANNAS. Works by Laimdota Malle (LV), alliance Kurss (LV), Rebecca Korn (UK), and Anastasia Shneps-Shneppe (LV). Curator: Kristiāna Kārklīņa. Three guided tours. Supported by Rīgas dome and VKKF.

Exhibition



8–10 May 2026

Atrodi mani, es esmu šeit

Group exhibition by students of the Latvian Academy of Art (LMA), produced as part of the course “Exhibition Making Practice for Artists”. Curated by Ieva Stalšene.

Exhibition



15 May – 8 June 2026

TP054K-01xG

Duo exhibition by Alīna Burlakova (b. 1992) and Viktorija Galkina (b. 1988). Opening 15 May with a vocal performance by Eleonora Kampe.

Exhibition



28 May 2026

Gallery Late (RAW): TP054K-01xG

Gallery Late evening within Riga Art Week, held inside the TP054K-01xG exhibition, with a performance by Elizabete Balčus.

Performance / Gallery Late

June – August 2026



12–22 June 2026

Produktu Dizaina Izstāde 2026

Annual product design exhibition by Rīgas Dizaina un mākslas vidusskola (RDMV), presenting a year of student work under the theme *Sezons no Slēgums*. Opening 11 June.

Exhibition



26 June – 3 July 2026

Macchiato XVI — Sauleszaķi

16th festival of the international collective Macchiato Celebratio artis. A week-long multimedia exhibition with seven artists, alongside concerts, a literature evening, contemporary dance, performances, workshops, an algorave, and DJ sets.

Festival



5–11 July 2026

ITEM — Shuffled Time

Seven-day performative week. Each day one artist or artist group receives a 24-hour window to Invoke, Temper, Elate, Mint the space, with a pre-scheduled intervention each day.

Festival / Performance



13–18 July 2026

Fotoklubs.lv Photo Exhibition

Photography exhibition by Fotoklubs.lv, open daily from 15:00 to 20:00.

Exhibition



20–24 July 2026

RAA Chess Week

A week celebrating chess and its cultural imprint, co-hosted with Ex Libris, with chess played daily in an informal atmosphere. Opened on 20 July — International Chess Day, in its 60th year — with talks by Bruno Rancis and Signe Kacēna, and closed on 24 July with theatrical chess scenes by Santa Didžus and Leonhard Horstmeyer.

Festival



21 July 2026

Tournament

Hands and Brain Tournament

Chess tournament played in pairs — one player moves the pieces, the other names only which piece to move. Organised by Signe Kacēna and Visvaldis Gercāns with RAA and Ex Libris. Part of RAA Chess Week.



22 July 2026

Opera

Blaise le Savetier

Riga premiere of the comic one-act Baroque opera by François-André Danican Philidor, composer and legendary chess player. Concert performance by the Lithuanian Baroque ensemble *Lieto Fine* with Latvian instrumentalists, directed by Evelina Brėdikytė. Part of RAA Chess Week.

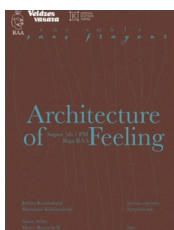


23 July 2026

Poetry / Music

Vienkārši sarežģīti

Poetry readings by nine poets of the collective *Sintakses stupors*, with songs by Zoya Zoyroko. Part of RAA Chess Week.



5 August 2026

Concert

Architecture of Feeling

Early Baroque concert by Ensemble Sans Frayeur (LT) — Justina Kaminskaitė (mezzo-soprano) and Skirmantė Kirkliauskaitė (harpsichord), with guests Marco Baronchelli (lute, IT), Marianna Puriņa (baroque violin) and Elfrīda Švalbe (baroque cello).